1960— The European Free Trade Association is set up.

1973— The Britain, Denmark and Ireland join the EEC.

1974— The European Council created. The European Regional Development Fund (ERDF) is set up.

1975— The Lomé Convention is signed between the European Communities (EC) and the African–Caribbean–Pacific (ACP) Group.

1978— The European Monetary System (EMS) proposed.

1979— The European Monetary System begins its operations.

1981— Greece becomes member of EC.

1986— Spain and Portugal join the EC.

1989— The fall of Berlin Wall.

1990— East and West Germany reunite. The European Bank for Reconstruction and Development is set up to support economic reforms and transition in the former Communist countries with major contributions from the EC. The Schengen Agreement to remove border controls is signed.

1991— Sweden applies to join EC.

1992— The Treaty of European Union signed in Maastricht on 7 February 1992. Finland and Switzerland apply to join the proposed EU.

1993— The Maastricht Treaty comes into force on 1 November 1993. The European Union came into existence.

1995— Austria, Finland and Sweden join EU. European currency named 'Euro'.[20]

1999— The Treaty of Amsterdam comes into force. A step towards the Common Foreign and Security Policy (CFSP).

2000— The Treaty of Nice.

2004— Constitution of the European Union adopted on 19 June 2004 in Brussels (but never came into force). Malta, Cyprus, Slovenia, Estonia, Latvia, Lithuania, Poland, the Czech Republic, Slovakia and Hungary join EU.

2007— Romania and Bulgaria join EU. Slovenia adopts the Euro.

The Institutions of European Union